



[Idea Title]

[One-line concept: what happens, in one sentence]

[Definition: 1–2 short sentences. What do participants do?]

FORMAT

[e.g., card game]

TIME

[e.g., 15 min]

PLAYERS

[e.g., 6+, pairs]

MATERIALS

[e.g., cards, timer]

Why this idea?

Grounding in the reading and the prompt

“ *[Paste a short quote from the reading]*

— Repairing Play, p.[]

How it responds to the prompt

[1–2 sentences: how does this turn play into a subject–object relationship?]

SUBJECT → OBJECT

PLAYER (subject)
[who?]



controls / captures

THE PLAYED (object)
[who?]

Voluntary for both? [yes / no]



How would it work?

01 Sub - Title 1

[roles, materials]

02 Sub - Title 2

[what happens]

03 Sub - Title 3

[the capture moment]

04 Sub - Title 4

[questions to ask]

Sketch · image · diagram · storyboard
(drop it here)

We will observe

- [moment 1]
- [moment 2]
- [moment 3]

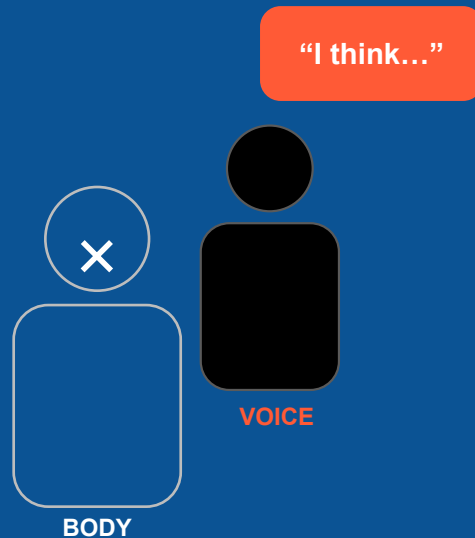
Safety: [how anyone can opt out]

Voice Swap

If you can't speak with your own mouth, are you in the conversation, or being played?

One person is the BODY and cannot speak.

Their partner, the VOICE, speaks for them in first person with no planning.



FORMAT

Role-based conversation game

TIME

15 min

PLAYERS

6+, in pairs

MATERIALS

Role cards, topic cards, timer

Why this idea?

Grounding in the reading and the prompt

“ *When we play, we transform others and the world around us into play-objects.*

— Repairing Play, p.69

How it responds to the prompt

Everyone agrees at the start, yet the BODY slowly becomes the played: their words are invented and their gestures can be ignored.

SUBJECT → OBJECT

PLAYER (subject)
the VOICE



speaks for

THE PLAYED (object)
the BODY

Voluntary for both? At the start, yes. After that?

How would it work?

01 Setup

Draw BODY / VOICE cards

02 Play

Intros, then opinions on light topics

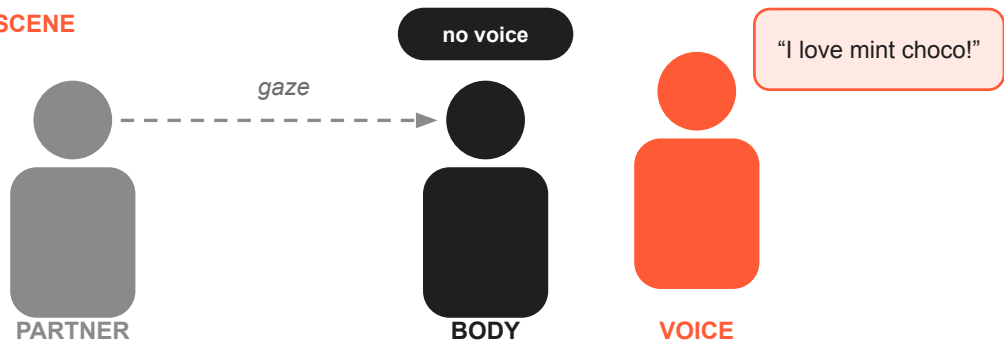
03 Twist

Swap roles, but one pair secretly can't

04 Debrief

"Who were you really talking to?"

THE SCENE



Partners must look at the BODY, not the VOICE.

We will observe

- BODY gesturing to object
- Where partners actually look
- Laughter turning awkward

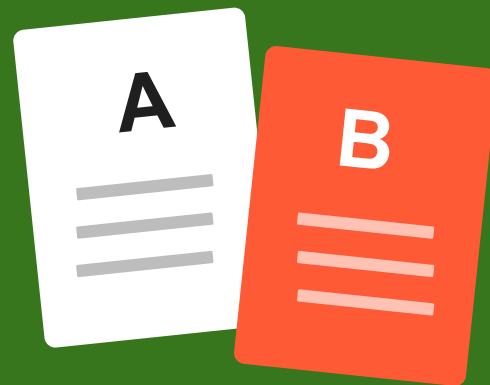
Safety: No put-downs of real people; anyone can step out anytime



Same Mission, Different Rules

Everyone plays the same game, but not everyone gets the same rules.

Two teams race to build the tallest paper tower. Each team secretly gets a different rulebook, and one team controls all the materials.



SEALED RULEBOOKS

FORMAT

Team building challenge

TIME

15 min

PLAYERS

6+, two teams

MATERIALS

Paper, tape, 2 sealed rulebooks, timer



Why this idea?

Grounding in the reading and the prompt

“ *There are different rules for different people here.*

— Repairing Play, p.56

How it responds to the prompt

Team B's play depends on Team A's choices, but Team A doesn't know it. The capture is invisible to those doing it: “one player's fun is another player's pain” (p.42).

SUBJECT → OBJECT

PLAYER (subject)
Team A



controls materials

THE PLAYED (object)
Team B

Voluntary for both? Both joined; only one knew.

How would it work?

01 Setup

Random teams, sealed rulebooks

02 Play

5-min tower race, no host help

03 Twist

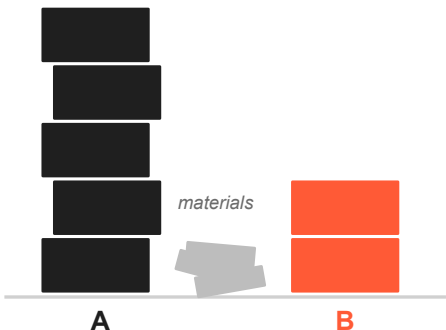
Read both rulebooks aloud

04 Debrief

“Did the winners really play better?”

Team A	Team B
Two hands	One hand each
Can talk	Gestures only
Owens all materials	Must ask A for every item

Sealed — never shown to the other team



We will observe

- Does A share or hoard?
- B's frustration signals
- The moment A realizes

Safety: Hear Team B first in the debrief; anyone can step out anytime



Obey the Machine

When a machine gives the orders, do we play along more easily?

A laptop “AI” gives small instructions, alternating with a human voice. At the end, we reveal a teammate was secretly typing for the “AI.”



FORMAT

Instruction game

TIME

13 min

PLAYERS

5+

MATERIALS

Laptop with
text-to-speech, command
list



Why this idea?

Grounding in the reading and the prompt

“

Do we negotiate consent when we play with a computer or with ourselves?

— Repairing Play, p.57

How it responds to the prompt

Participants become the machine's play-objects.

Does a non-human “player” make capture feel more natural, or more invisible?

SUBJECT → OBJECT

PLAYER (subject)
the “AI” (a hidden human)



commands

THE PLAYED (object)
participants

Voluntary for both? Did anyone ever say no?

How would it work?

01 Setup

Laptop up front, teammate typing in secret

02 Play

AI and human commands take turns, slowly escalating

03 Twist

Contradicting commands, then reveal the “AI”

04 Debrief

“Who was really playing whom?”

COMMANDS ESCALATE

↑ *Two Commanders moment*

AI

“Stand up.”

HUMAN

“Swap seats with someone in black.”

AI

“Tell your neighbor your favorite snack.”

AI + HUMAN

“Sit down!” / “Clap!”
at once

We will observe

- Hesitation: AI vs. human
- Who skips or refuses
- Reactions to the reveal

Safety: All commands pre-approved; any command can be skipped

License to Speak

Who decides when you're allowed to speak, and in which language?

Each player draws a random language card that limits how they can talk. The group must reach one shared decision. Permission to speak freely is given, then taken back.



FORMAT

Card-based talk game

TIME

12–15 min

PLAYERS

6+

MATERIALS

Language cards, task card, timer

Why this idea?

Grounding in the reading and the prompt

“ *Play is voluntary, but only to the players who initiate the experience.*

— Repairing Play, p.68

How it responds to the prompt

Everyone plays the same task under unequal language rules (p.56). The 30-second “any language” moment works like a safe word someone else controls (pp.79–80).

SUBJECT → OBJECT

PLAYER (subject)
the host who grants permission



grants / revokes

THE PLAYED (object)
the card holders

Voluntary for both? Who asked for the 30 seconds?

How would it work?

01 Setup

Hand out random language cards

02 Play

5-min group task: agree on one dinner menu

03 Twist

“30 seconds: any language!” Then take it back

04 Debrief

“Who gave you permission to speak?”

LANGUAGE CARDS (RANDOM)



English only



Gestures only



Free



3 words max

0 min

30s: any language → revoked

5 min

We will observe

- Who talks, who goes quiet
- The 30-second moment
- Rule-bending

Safety: Cards are always random, never based on real English level



[I AM A KING]

[How to govern your people]

A fixed job list is needed; you must place the students (or their classmates) in their proper positions.

FORMAT

[card game (?)]

TIME

[15min]
(Perhaps it could be designed to include Game 2.)

PLAYERS

[ALL]

MATERIALS

[pen, photos, double-sided tape]

Why this idea?

When we play, we transform others and the world around us into **play-object**

“ *When we play, we transform others and the world around us into play-object.*

— Repairing Play, p.[69]

How it responds to the prompt

In the book that play was used as a tool of colonization. In fact, the world now also treats "human resources" as a play-object. When you are in a country, society will force you to find a "place that suits you". You can choose what kind of work you want to do, but you cannot choose to make the company want you.

SUBJECT → OBJECT

PLAYER (subject)
[ALL STUDENTS - 25]



controls / captures

THE PLAYED (object)
[ALL STUDENTS - 25]

Voluntary for both? [yes / no]

How would it work?

01 Self-Awareness

If you lived in a country, what position would you want to hold? (There's a checkbox)

- ☐ King
- ☐ Queen
- ☐ Knight
- ☐ Artist
- ☐ Engineer
- ☐ Magician
- ☐ Fortune Teller
- ☐ Worker (Manual Laborer)
- ☐ Cook
- ☐ Diplomat - English
- ☐ Diplomat - Chinese
- ☐ Diplomat - Korean
- ☐ Premier
- ☐ Businessman
- ☐ Judge
- ☐ ...

02 Allocate human resources

Now that you are the king, please compile a list of your subjects and write down the reasons behind it.



03 ???

04

Will this pique everyone's curiosity?
Want to know who hired you?
Want to know if people put you in the position you wanted?

We will observe

- Will everyone discuss this
- Will they create their own

Safety: [how anyone can opt out]



[I'm such an abstract person]

The you you paint, the you you describe, the you others know.

You will first draw your own self-portrait.

Others will draw you based on your description.

Another person will draw you based solely on your appearance and write down descriptive words.

FORMAT

[drawing]

TIME

[2+4+4]

PLAYERS

[self , pairs , pairs]

MATERIALS

[paper, pen]

Why this idea?

Own-subjective experience & be treated as an Object -> Double Consciousness

“

If play is a subject-object relationship, how should one reconcile their own subjective experience with the fact that through play they will be treated as an object?
To answer this question of what it means to objectify one's self, we must turn to philosophy concerned with the phenomenon of double consciousness and the Black experience.

— Repairing Play, p.[69]

How it responds to the prompt

How would we try to understand ourselves from an "objective perspective"?

How would we want others to understand us?

SUBJECT → OBJECT

PLAYER (subject)
YOU



controls / captures

THE PLAYED (object)
YOU

Voluntary for both? [yes / no]

How would it work?

01 You Paint

You will first draw a portrait of yourself.

02 You describe

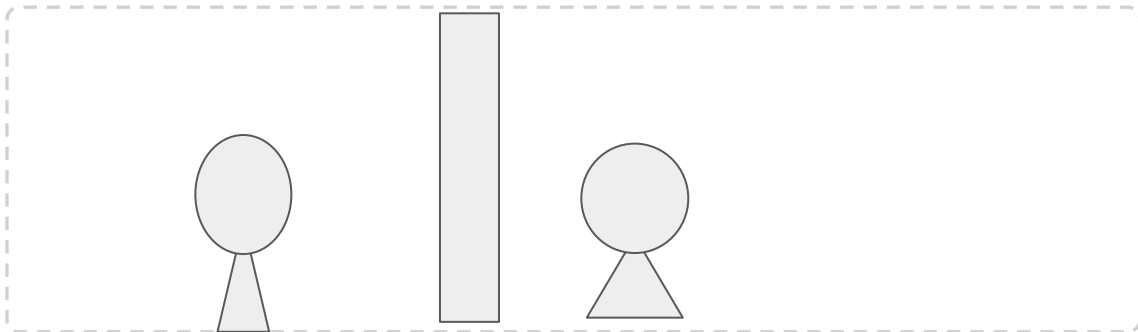
Then you will be randomly paired up, with the other person unable to see you (through a curtain). You will describe all your characteristics (including your identity, hairstyle, skin color, personality, anything), and the listener will draw your appearance.

03 Be Painted

Then you will move on to the next person, who will not listen to anything you say, but will simply draw your "appearance" and write down descriptive words.

04 Sub - Title 4

[questions to ask]



We will observe

- Curious about how I'll be drawn
- Care about how well I draw others' drawings

Safety: [how anyone can opt out]



[Label]

When your subject and object are visualized

Give your classmate a nickname and write the reason on the back.

FORMAT

[Write something]

TIME

[5min]

PLAYERS

[self]

MATERIALS

[paper, pen]



Why this idea?

Own-subjective experience & be treated as an Object -> Double Consciousness

“

If play is a subject-object relationship, how should one reconcile their own subjective experience with the fact that through play they will be treated as an object?
To answer this question of what it means to objectify one's self, we must turn to philosophy concerned with the phenomenon of double consciousness and the Black experience.

— Repairing Play, p.[69]

How it responds to the prompt

We often give our friends nicknames. Is that a form of labeling?
But is it also a sign of intimacy?
Does your self-perception align with the labels others give you?

SUBJECT → OBJECT

PLAYER (subject)
YOU



controls / captures

THE PLAYED (object)
YOUR CLASSMATE

Voluntary for both? [yes / no]

How would it work?

01 Sub - Title 1

[roles, materials]

02 Sub - Title 2

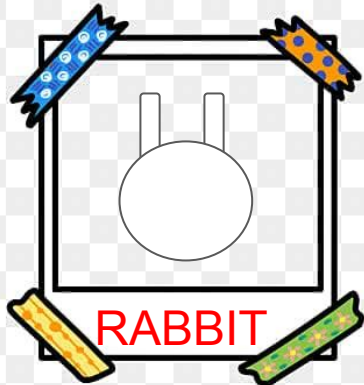
[what happens]

03 Sub - Title 3

[the capture moment]

04 Sub - Title 4

[questions to ask]



storyboard

We will observe

- [moment 1]
- [moment 2]
- [moment 3]

Safety: [how anyone can opt out]



Tiggers

One-line concept: Everyone knows each person has an individual small-action trigger set in advance. People chat and move freely for five minutes with no real-time feedback. At the end, triggered names are announced, and the group guesses each person's pre-written private trigger.

Definition: The general idea of the game is shared with everyone. Only the dictator-subject has pre-written the unique trigger assigned to each participant. Players know the format, but cannot know their own specific trigger, which is set before the game begins.

FORMAT

Free social observation
game

TIME

8 min

PLAYERS

5+

MATERIALS

pen, paper, timer

Why this idea?

Grounding in the reading and the prompt

“*‘play is voluntary for the player, but not necessarily voluntary for the played’*

— Repairing Play, p.[69]

How it responds to the prompt

Although everyone chooses to join the game, only the dictator pre-sets each person's unique trigger. Participants become the played, judged by personalized criteria they cannot create, see, or change.

SUBJECT → OBJECT

PLAYER (subject)
The Dictator



THE PLAYED (object)
All others participants

Voluntary for both? [no]



How would it work?

01 Set up&Roles

One Dictator uses pen and paper to write a unique private action trigger for every participant. No one else sees this list. Everyone is told the general rule: each person has their own unknown trigger action.

02 Run to game

People sit in a circle, chat and move freely for 8 minutes. The dictator silently marks anyone who does their assigned trigger. No hints or feedback are given during play.

03 Capture

A participant performs their pre-assigned trigger without knowing it. They are already being recorded by a standard that was decided for them before the game even began.

04 Question

1. How did it feel knowing you might have a hidden trigger tailored just for you?
2. Did you start second-guessing your own small gestures while socializing?

We will observe

- Players growing self-conscious of their casual movements
- Confusion when the list of triggered names is announced
- Participants trying hard to recall what they were doing

Safety: Anyone can step out of the game at any time simply by raising their hand.



Conflicting Beats

One-line concept: Two commanders randomly issue conflicting beats and movement commands, either at the same time or at different moments, and all other participants must try to follow both sets of instructions at once.

Definition: Commanders invent rhythms and physical actions spontaneously with no prior agreement. Followers cannot change the rules and have to keep attempting both demands throughout the game

FORMAT

Body-based interactive
game

TIME

5min

PLAYERS

6+

MATERIALS

/



Why this idea?

Grounding in the reading and the prompt

“

‘When we play, we transform others and the world around us into play-objects.’

— Repairing Play, p.[69]

How it responds to the prompt

Our experiment actualises this transformation. The two commanders act as subjects, issuing conflicting physical commands. Followers are turned into play-objects, forced to bodily respond to demands they cannot negotiate or refuse.

SUBJECT → OBJECT

PLAYER (subject)
2 Commanders



controls

THE PLAYED (object)
All Followers

Voluntary for both? [no]



How would it work?

01 Set up&Roles

Two commanders are chosen at the start. All remaining participants are followers. No extra materials are needed.

02 Run to game

Commanders call out beats and body movements randomly, either at the same time or separately. Followers keep trying to perform both actions together for 8 minutes.

03 Capture

When followers cannot physically do both conflicting actions at once and still keep trying to satisfy both commanders.

04 Questions

How does it feel to follow two different directions at once? When do you notice there is no way to satisfy both?

We will observe

- Moments when followers hesitate or freeze between two conflicting movements
- Moments where followers prioritize one command over the other
- Moments where followers give up trying to follow both

Safety: Anyone can step out of the game at any time, no explanation needed. Simply raise one hand to signal you are taking a break.



Shifted Narrative

One-line concept: Everyone first witnesses the exact same small real-life event. In turn, each participant must deliberately change at least one detail when retelling what they saw, even though they know the full truth.

[Definition: Participants voluntarily join, yet are denied the choice to tell the truth. Capture comes from a structural requirement to actively distort what everyone knows to be real.]

FORMAT

Narrative-retelling game

TIME

5min

PLAYERS

5+

MATERIALS

timer

Why this idea?

Grounding in the reading and the prompt

“*‘play is voluntary for the player, but not necessarily voluntary for the played’*

— Repairing Play, p.[69]

How it responds to the prompt

While participants choose to join, the person who sets the original action unilaterally enforces a rule that takes away their freedom to describe the event truthfully. They are positioned as the played.

SUBJECT → OBJECT

PLAYER (subject)

[The person who sets the original action]



THE PLAYED (object)

[All participating storytellers]

Voluntary for both? [no]



How would it work?

01 Set up&Roles

The person who sets the original action performs a simple physical event for everyone to watch. They announce the one mandatory rule: every speaker must change at least one detail from the original event when they share.

02 Run to game

Participants take turns speaking. Each person draws from the original event they all saw, and intentionally modifies one detail. They are not copying or changing the previous speaker's version.

03 Capture

A participant knows exactly what really happened, yet must deliberately alter their story to follow the rule. Their freedom to tell the plain truth has already been taken away.

04 Questions

1. How did it feel to knowingly change a story we all saw?
2. What made you pick which detail to alter?

We will observe

- Participants hesitating before they choose which detail to change
- Small signs of discomfort when they have to distort what they know is true
- Different creative choices of what each person decides to alter

Safety: Anyone can step out of the game at any time, no explanation needed. Simply raise one hand to signal you are taking a break.